

Step 2 — Test locally

Before opening a PR, verify your script works locally. From the repo root:

1

Build the Docker image

```
docker build -f .helix/Dockerfile.helix -t helix-tests .
```

2

Run all tests (no arguments)

```
docker run --rm -t helix-tests ./helix/run-tests-eval.sh
```

3

Run specific tests (with file paths)

```
docker run --rm -t helix-tests ./helix/run-tests-eval.sh
tests/example_test1.py,tests/example_test2.py
```

[Replace the filepaths with the location of tests in your repository.]

4

Confirm both modes pass

Both modes should exit cleanly before you push.

Debugging build failures

If the Docker build fails, check that your Dockerfile.helix uses the correct base image and installs all required dependencies. Compare against the repo's CI config or dependency files (e.g. requirements.txt, package.json, Gemfile) for clues.

P2P tests that need live ports or external services

Some P2P tests depend on live ports, external network services, or host-only resources that can't be reproduced inside the Docker container. If you encounter these, skip them in run-tests-eval.sh (e.g. with a pytest -k filter, a build-tag exclusion in Go, an it.skip block in JS, etc.) so the Docker PR can still pass cleanly. Document which tests were skipped and why in the PR description so the reviewer knows it was intentional.

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